

CITA01 – FOUNDATIONS OF CITY STUDIES SUMMER 2026

MAY 11, 2026

COURSE INSTRUCTOR: OLIVIA BERNARD



Settler
Colonialization
and Urbanization

Objectives

Assignment I

Urbanization
of The
Human
Population

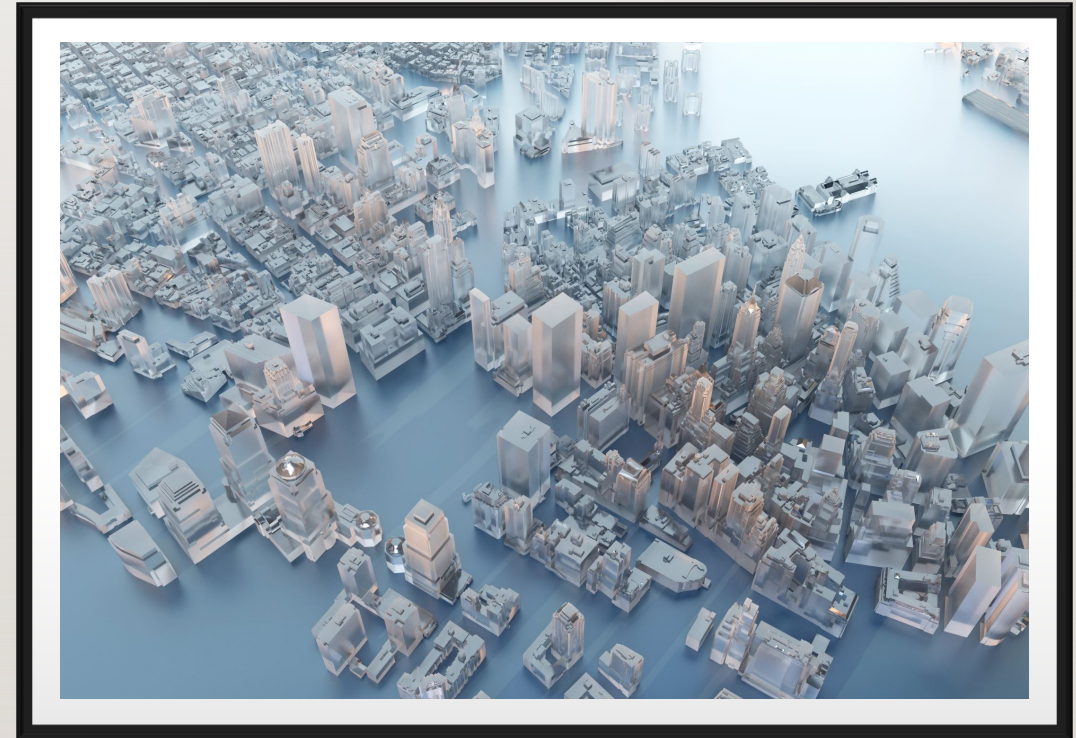
The
Evolution
of Cities

The Origins of
Cities

ASSIGNMENT 1 - VIDEO OR ANNOTATED PODCAST MIND MAP AND OUTLINE

Objective: This assignment aims to familiarize you with analyzing and reflecting on different source types. You will learn how to make connections across different sources and critique city planning measures in the city where you currently reside.

- Due: **June 15, 2026.**
- Worth **10%** of your final mark.
- Please watch the [Welcome to India Documentary.](#)



ASSIGNMENT 1 - VIDEO OR ANNOTATED PODCAST MIND MAP AND OUTLINE

Mind Map

Using the main arguments in the video, you will brainstorm and conceptualize a streamlined topic based on the city you currently reside.

1. What is one key term from the course that the documentary connects to?
2. What is your streamlined topic, and where will it be based?
3. What is a case study or a local example you want to focus on?
4. How does this connect to the video? What are two of the main points that intersect?
5. You will then draw on one current news source to support and make connections to your topic.

ASSIGNMENT 1 - VIDEO OR ANNOTATED PODCAST MIND MAP AND OUTLINE

Outline – 800 - 1000 words

This is where you will further develop your research, using the mind map

1. Explain the key term used in the mind map and make connections to a course reading. How does your streamlined topic connect to this term?
2. Explain the connections between your streamlined topic and the news article from your research.
3. Discuss your case study. What are some of the points that intersect across the three sources?
4. Using your case study, how does the news article support or go against some of the main tenets?

ASSIGNMENT 1 - VIDEO OR ANNOTATED PODCAST MIND MAP AND OUTLINE

Outline – 800 - 1000 words

Reflect and make connections to the city that you are currently living in.

1. What is one area that you agreed with and one argument that you disagreed with from the documentary? Use timestamps to aid in your explanation. How does this connect to your streamlined topic/case study?
2. What questions were still lingering in your mind after watching the documentary? Did the news article and/or course article address these questions? Why or why not?
3. Using the course article/lecture discussions, provide one strategy or plan of action you believe the city can implement to address one of the issues mentioned above. How would this action impact people's lives in the region? You can discuss an alternate strategy based on your research; however, connections should be made to the course.

ASSIGNMENT 1 - VIDEO OR ANNOTATED PODCAST MIND MAP AND OUTLINE

- **Format and Requirements:**

Include your name, student number, course code, the instructor's and TA's names in the header of the first page.

- Single-spaced for the outline
- Times New Roman, 12pt
- Do not use point form
- Reference list - You must cite exactly three sources: (1) One course reading/article, (2) the documentary, and (3) one news article from your research. Your news source should not be older than 1 year. APA guidelines.
- Mind maps must be hand-drawn. Use a particular label or colours to make connections to the course.

57% of the
world's population
live in urban areas



WHAT IS THE PERCENTAGE OF CANADIANS LIVING IN
THE COUNTRY'S CENSUS METROPOLITAN AREAS?

A. 35%

B. 48%

C.
84%

WHAT IS THE PERCENTAGE OF CANADIANS LIVING IN THE COUNTRY'S
THREE LARGEST CMAS?

A. 25%

B. 35%

C. 58%

WHAT ARE CANADA'S SIX LARGEST CMAS?

```
mirror_mod = modifier_ob.  
set mirror object to mirror.  
mirror_mod.mirror_object
```

```
operation == "MIRROR_X":  
mirror_mod.use_x = True  
mirror_mod.use_y = False  
mirror_mod.use_z = False  
operation == "MIRROR_Y":  
mirror_mod.use_x = False  
mirror_mod.use_y = True  
mirror_mod.use_z = False  
operation == "MIRROR_Z":  
mirror_mod.use_x = False  
mirror_mod.use_y = False  
mirror_mod.use_z = True
```

```
selection at the end -add  
mirror_ob.select= 1  
modifier_ob.select=1  
context.scene.objects.active  
("Selected" + str(modifier_ob.  
mirror_ob.select = 0  
= bpy.context.selected_object  
data.objects[one.name].select  
print("please select exactly
```

```
-- OPERATOR CLASSES --
```

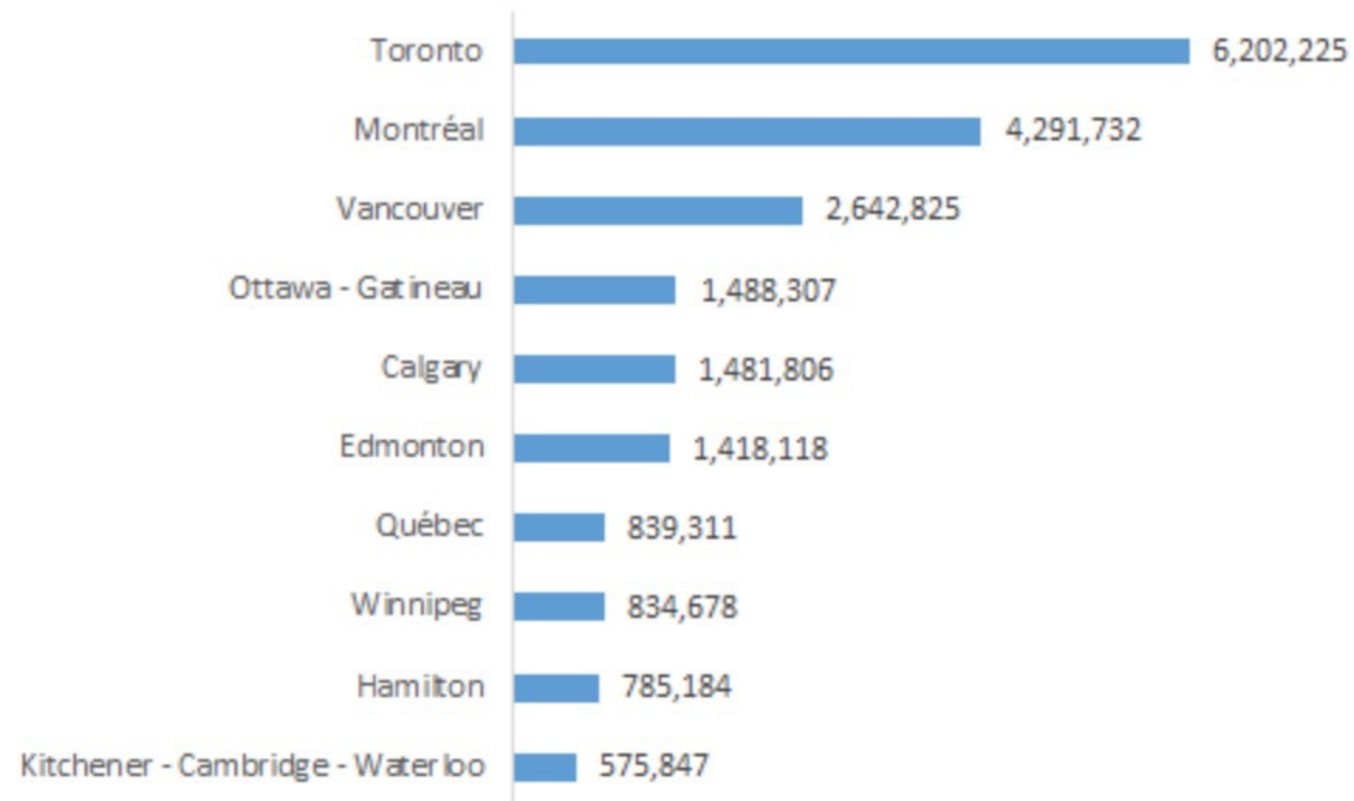
```
types.Operator):  
X mirror to the selected  
object.mirror_mirror_x"  
mirror X"
```

```
context):  
context.active_object is not
```

Toronto
Montreal
Vancouver

Ottawa-Gatineau
Calgary
Edmonton

Population of Canada's ten largest census metropolitan areas



Source: Statistics Canada, 2021 Census of Population.

STATISTICS CANADA'S DEFINITION OF 'URBAN'

- Since 1971 Statistics Canada has defined places as “urban” if they have more than 1000 inhabitants and a population density of at least 400 people/square kilometre;
- This approach ignores differences among places classified as urban;
- Recently, Statistics Canada replaced the term “urban area” with “population centre” and;
- Introduced a distinction between small, medium and large population centres to better reflect a rural-urban continuum rather than a strict dichotomy between urban and rural.

ORIGINS OF CITIES

```
for object to mirror_mod.mirror_object
operation == "MIRROR_X":
    mirror_mod.use_x = True
    mirror_mod.use_y = False
    mirror_mod.use_z = False
operation == "MIRROR_Y":
    mirror_mod.use_x = False
    mirror_mod.use_y = True
    mirror_mod.use_z = False
operation == "MIRROR_Z":
    mirror_mod.use_x = False
    mirror_mod.use_y = False
    mirror_mod.use_z = True
```

```
selection at the end -add key
mirror_ob.select= 1
modifier_ob.select=1
```

```
context.scene.objects.active
("Selected" + str(modifier_ob))
mirror_ob.select = 0
bpy.context.selected_objects
data.objects[one.name].select
print("please select exactly 1")
```

```
===== OPERATOR CLASSES =====
```

```
types.Operator):
    mirror to the selected
```


Settler Colonialism and Urbanization

- Cities have been important areas where colonial relations were enacted and have played a major role in the administration of colonial regimes. What does this mean?
- Cities have been identified as important spaces of colonial expansion and dispossession. As places of **unequal power dynamics**, and the concentration of settler population and resources, **cities have proved vital instruments of colonization**

Settler Colonialism and Urbanization

- Settler colonialism refers to the dispossession of Indigenous lands, displacement of Indigenous peoples and ongoing acts of violence to cement colonial powers within a nation. It is more than resource extraction.
- Settler colonialism is based on the theft of land and resources, and attempted elimination of Indigenous peoples as central logics driving the process
- Canadian laws, enacted by various levels of government has been one of the main tools used in settler colonialism to displace Indigenous people's rights and lands.

GORDON CHILDE (1892-1957)

- One of the most influential archaeologists of the 20th century;
- “The Urban Revolution” published in Town Planning Review (1950);
- Childe applied social science concepts to archaeological data and revolutionized the discipline;
- Childe developed a materialist theory of the origins of cities: **analyzing the means of production, technological and physical resources, and social relations.**



GORDON CHILDE (1892-1957)

“We find certain types of remains – pots, implements, ornaments, burial rites and house forms – constantly recurring together. Such a complex of associated traits we shall call a "cultural group" or just a "culture". We assume that such a complex is the material expression of what today we would call "a people.”

- Gordon Childe, The Danube in Prehistory, 1929

STAGES OF
HUMAN
DEVELOPMENT
(G. CHILDE, 1936)



Paleolithic



Neolithic



Urban



Industrial

THREE KEY SHIFTS IN THE HISTORY OF HUMAN DEVELOPMENT

**1. Neolithic
Revolution**

**2. Urban
Revolution**

**3. Industrial
Revolution**

NEOLITHIC REVOLUTION (8000 BCE)

(FROM PALEOLITHIC
TO NEOLITHIC
PERIOD)



From hunting-and-gathering to agriculture;



Agricultural revolution;



Domestication of plants and animals;



Division of labour and specialization;

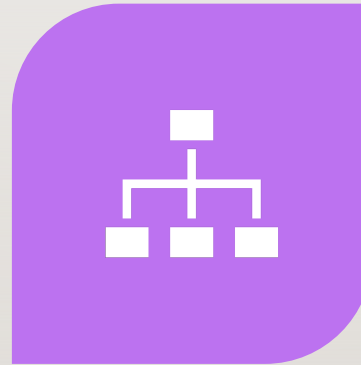


More complex social structures.

ELEMENTS OF SOCIAL CHANGE



1. SOCIAL DIVISION OF
LABOUR;



2. HIERARCHICAL POWER
STRUCTURES;



3. THE DEVELOPMENT OF
A PRODUCTIVE SURPLUS.

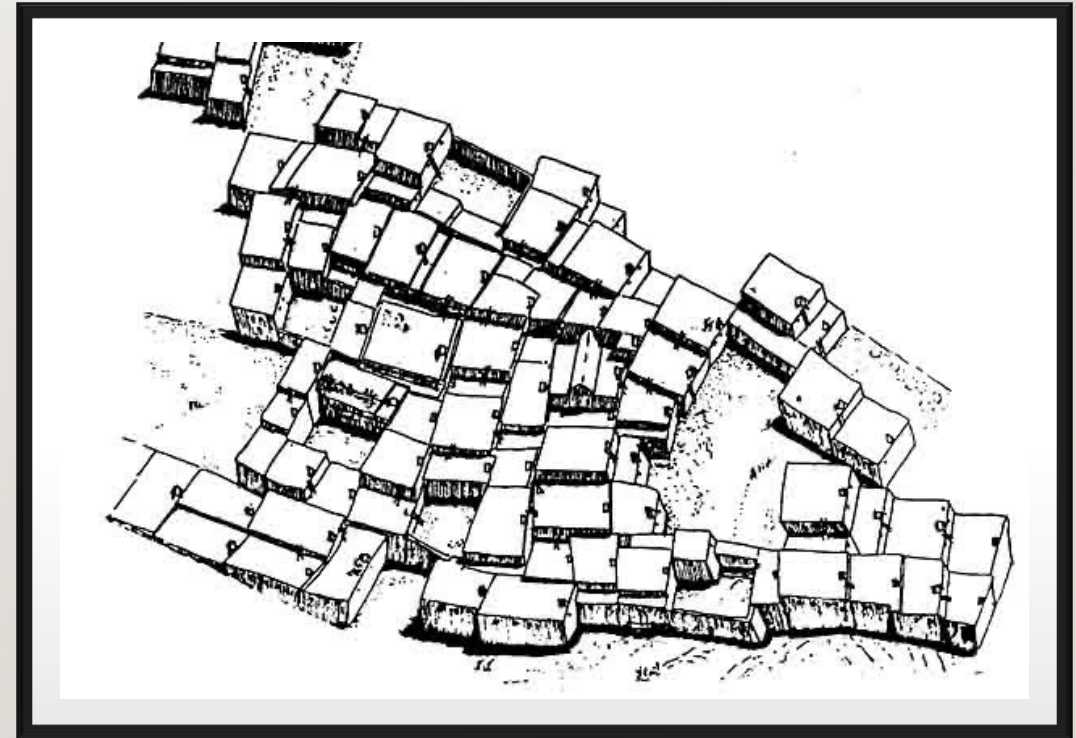
JERICHO

- Emerged about 9,000 BCE
- Relatively small population
- Houses made of sundried brick
- Surrounding wall
- Complex built environment suggests a division of labour



ÇATAL HÜYÜK

- Emerged about 7,500 BCE;
- Largest and best-preserved Neolithic settlement;
- The settlement was a collection of domestic buildings;
- No obvious public buildings and no streets



Çatal Hüyük (present-day Turkey)

CHILDE'S 'URBAN REVOLUTION' - 10 CRITERIA



1. Large settlements and high density;



2. Specialization / Advanced division of labor;



3. Significant agricultural surplus;



4. Public architecture;



5. The emergence of a ruling class;

CHILDE'S 'URBAN REVOLUTION' - 10 CRITERIA

6. The development of script and writing;
7. Predictive sciences (arithmetic, geometry, astronomy, calendars);
8. Development of arts and crafts;
9. Long-distance trade;
10. Political organization and state structures.

MESOPOTAMIA

- Development of large cities about 4,000 BCE;
- Urban space dominated by monumental architecture;
- Presence of a large religious, political and military ruling class;
- Cities controlled their hinterland: “urban empires” and “city states.”



City of Ur, Mesopotamia (present-day Iraq)





BREAK - 5 MINUTES

EVOLUTION OF CITIES

```
mirror object to mirror_
mirror_mod.mirror_object =
operation == "MIRROR_X":
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mirror_mod.use_z = False
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context.scene.objects.active
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mirror_ob.select = 0
bpy.context.selected_object
data.objects[one.name].select

print("please select exactly

--- OPERATOR CLASSES -----
```


Urbanization

- **Urbanization**

The increase over time of the proportion of the total human population that is urban as opposed to rural.

Broken down:

- A broad set of processes taking place to **transform space**
- Material, economic, and demographic **growth and development**
- Socio-material transformations in the built environment
- Connections that settlements are making with places and processes well beyond their own borders

URBANIZATION AND POPULATION CHANGE

- According to Davis – “Between 1850 and 1950 the index changed at a much higher rate than from 1800 to 1850, but the rate of change from 1950 to 1960 was twice that of the preceding 50 years”.
- “The later each country became industrialized, the faster was its urbanization”.
- “The change from a population with 10 percent of its members in cities of 100,000 or larger to one in which 30 percent lived in such cities took about 79 years in England and Wales, 66 in the U.S., 48 in Germany, 36 in Japan and 26 in Australia. The close association between economic development and urbanization has persisted”

INDUSTRIAL REVOLUTION

“Industrial Revolution in England, along with rapid population growth, combined with rural–urban shifts to change both the proportion of the population living in cities and absolute city size very quickly”.

Economic growth, demographic change and technological advancements during the Industrial Revolution in North America and Europe produced significant urban transition.

“Cities like Manchester and Liverpool in UK, Essen and Dortmund in Germany, and Chicago and Pittsburgh in the USA developed during this period”.

‘Large flow of people from farms to cities’ was generated in every country that passed through the industrial revolution”.



FACTORS PROPELLING URBANIZATION

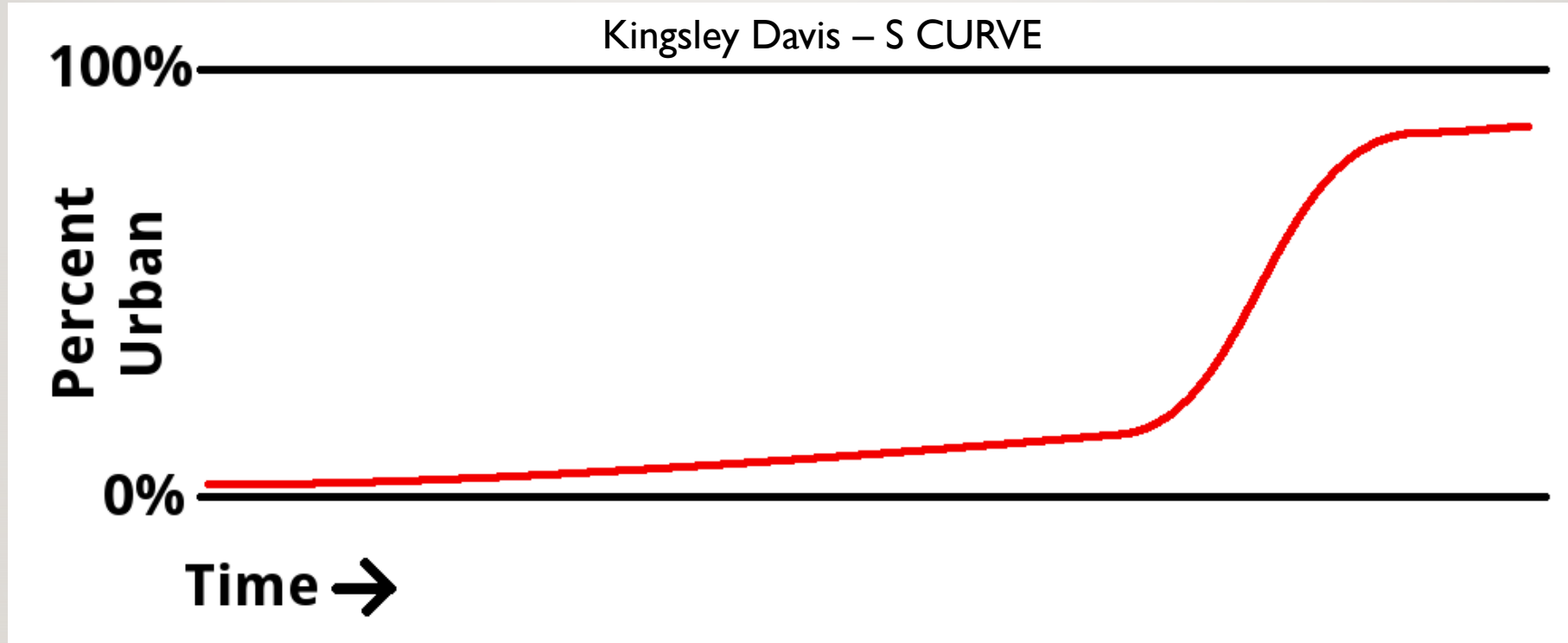
- Rural to urban migration
- Demographic changes
- City cleanup and increase in life expectancy

KINGSLEY DAVIS – S CURVE

Davis argues that urbanization follows an attenuated S-curve in which pre-industrial cities urbanize very slowly at the long bottom of the S, shoot up at the middle of the S as they industrialize, and then level off at the top of the S.



Advanced industrialized countries are now reaching the top part of an S-curve, many rapidly urbanizing Third World countries are at the steep middle of the S, and other emerging countries are still moving along the long slowly rising bottom of the S



WHAT ARE SOME EXAMPLES FOR EACH MAIN PART OF THE CURVE?

URBANIZATION IN DEVELOPING NATIONS

- “Contemporary underdeveloped populations have been growing since 1940 **more than twice as fast as industrialized populations**, and their increase far exceeds the growth of the latter at the peak of their expansion”.
- “Throughout the nonindustrial world people in cities are multiplying as never before, and **rural–urban migration is playing a much lesser role**”
- “Slum” and informal settlements.

CRITIQUES

Davis's arguments are important in theorizing urbanization and population growth

However, his arguments have been critiqued as being **teleological**: that it implies a linear form of urbanization that is not place-specific

It overlooks important criteria, such as the impact of colonialism, war, plagues, political ideology, religion, etc.

- It is written from a **Eurocentric** perspective

DISCUSSION

What is the importance of the Industrial Revolution in propelling urbanization? What is the main factor driving urbanization in your city? Please respond in 200 – 250 words.

Next Steps

- I. Complete the course readings for next week and come ensure you attend your first tutorial.

The Processes of Contemporary Urbanization.

- Adeniyi-Ogunyankin, G., Ninglekhu, S. and Rankin, K. (2023) The Right to the City: “The Slum” and Informal Urbanisms. In Bain, A.L. and Peake, L. (eds) Urbanization in a Global Context (pp. 63 – 79). Don Mills, ON: Oxford University Press.
- United Nations Human Settlements Program (UN-HABITAT). 2015 [2003]. “Key Findings and Messages” Pp. 659-665 in The City Reader.
- Massey, D. (2008) A Global Sense of Place. in The Cultural Geography Reader.

